

# AIR INDIA

Complete Travel Information Guide

Baggage • Airport • First-Time Flyers • Visas & Documents • Health & Medical • Pets

June 2026

# Table of Contents

---

|                                                  |          |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>1. Baggage Guidelines</b>                     | <b>3</b> |
| Cabin / Carry-on Baggage                         |          |
| Checked Baggage                                  |          |
| Restricted Items & Baggage Advisory              |          |
| Excess Baggage                                   |          |
| Special & Unaccompanied Baggage                  |          |
| Lost or Damaged Baggage & Tracking               |          |
| Prepaid Baggage & International Airport Policies |          |
| <b>2. Airport Information</b>                    | <b>5</b> |
| Lounges & Facilities                             |          |
| Travelling Through Multiple Airports             |          |
| <b>3. First-Time Flyers &amp; Children</b>       | <b>6</b> |
| Tips for First-Time Flyers                       |          |
| Unaccompanied Minors & Young Passengers          |          |
| Expectant Mothers & Infants                      |          |
| <b>4. Visas, Documents &amp; Travel Tips</b>     | <b>7</b> |
| Required Documents & Travel Advisories           |          |
| <b>5. Health &amp; Medical Assistance</b>        | <b>8</b> |
| Medical Needs & Clearance                        |          |
| Disability Assistance                            |          |
| Wheelchair Requirements                          |          |
| <b>6. Travelling with Pets</b>                   | <b>9</b> |
| Pet in Cabin                                     |          |
| Pets as Checked Baggage                          |          |
| Required Documents                               |          |

# 1. Baggage Guidelines

Know Before You Go: Ultimate Guide to Packing for Travel

## Overview

Whether you are packing for a solo trip across Europe or taking the family to the Far East, Air India provides comprehensive baggage information to help you prepare. This section covers everything from cabin baggage limits to excess baggage charges and special items.

## Cabin / Carry-on Baggage

As per Indian security regulations (BCAS "One Hand Baggage Rule", Circular 6/2000, dated 24 Feb 2000), passengers may carry **only one piece of hand baggage**. This rule applies to all travel classes, regardless of Maharaja Club or STAR Alliance frequent flyer status, for both international and domestic flights.

### Key cabin baggage rules:

- Maximum dimensions: 55 cm x 35 cm x 25 cm (L x W x H)
- Weight limit: 8 kg for domestic and international flights
- One bag only — no exceptions based on frequent flyer status

### Kirpan Policy:

- Passengers may carry a kirpan on their person only on flights operating within India
- The kirpan must meet specified size restrictions
- Kirpans are NOT permitted on international flights or from the Security Hold Area (SHA) of international terminals

⚠ Note: It is each passenger's responsibility to ensure that hazardous, unsafe, or prohibited items are not carried in cabin baggage.

## Checked Baggage

Checked baggage allowances vary depending on travel class, fare family, route, and Maharaja Club membership status.

## Smart Fare Families (2026):

| Fare Family | Domestic | Gulf Routes | USA / Europe / UK |
|-------------|----------|-------------|-------------------|
| Value       | 15 kg    | 25 kg       | 1 x 23 kg         |
| Classic     | 25 kg    | 30 kg       | 2 x 23 kg         |
| Flex        | 25 kg    | 30 kg       | 2 x 23 kg         |

- Single piece maximum weight ceiling: **32 kg** across all routes
- Additional baggage allowance is not applicable on ATR/CRJ aircraft, airline partner flights, or Air India codeshare flights

## Interline Journeys (IATA Rules):

- Step 1: If all participating carriers share the same baggage provisions, those apply
- Step 2: If provisions differ, common provisions apply; where all differ, the Most Significant Carrier (MSC) rules apply
- For codeshare flights, the operating carrier's rules apply unless stated otherwise

## Restricted Items & Baggage Advisory

Air India maintains a detailed list of items that are either prohibited or subject to restrictions in both cabin and checked baggage.

### Alcohol:

- Total net quantity permitted: 5 litres (169 oz) per person
- Must be in original retail packaging
- Individual receptacle must not exceed 5 litres

### General Prohibited/Restricted Categories:

- Hazardous materials and dangerous goods
- Sharp objects and weapons (subject to specific rules per route)
- Flammable, explosive, or corrosive substances
- Certain electronics with lithium batteries — check specific airline guidelines

Always refer to the Air India Baggage Advisory on the official website for the latest prohibited items list before travel.

## Excess Baggage

If you need to carry more than your free baggage allowance, Air India provides options to pre-purchase additional baggage at a lower cost compared to airport rates.

- Prepaid excess baggage can be purchased online before travel for significant savings
- For multi-city travel, prepaid excess baggage applies only when the passenger is in transit and baggage is checked through to the final destination

- If baggage is collected at any intermediate airport, additional charges may apply
- Use the Baggage Calculator on the Air India website to determine allowances and costs

## Special Baggage

Air India accommodates a wide variety of special items, including musical instruments and sports equipment.

### Musical Instruments:

- Can be carried as part of flight baggage; specific guidelines apply
- Large instruments may require an extra seat booking

### Sports Equipment:

- Inform Air India at least 24–48 hours before departure
- Must be securely packed; protective cases may be required
- Handling charges apply; excess baggage charges may apply if over Free Baggage Allowance
- Sporting firearms or ammunition require additional approvals and documentation

### Sportspersons' Special Allowance:

- Available to sportspersons travelling domestically or internationally for competitions or representing the country
- Identification document of the sport is required

### Cremated Human Remains (Ashes):

- Domestic flights: Permitted in cabin and checked baggage; no documents required; security screening applies
- International from India: Permitted in cabin and checked baggage; subject to destination country import regulations (e.g., Death Certificate or Cremation Certificate)
- International to India: Requirements depend on country of departure and India's import/health regulations

## Lost or Damaged Baggage

Air India has procedures to assist passengers when baggage is delayed, lost, or damaged.

- Use the WorldTracer Baggage Tracing System by entering your details to track delayed or lost baggage
- Report damaged or missing baggage at the airport immediately upon arrival
- Air India provides a checked baggage tracker feature in the mobile app

## Prepaid Baggage Charges

- Book additional baggage online using the prepaid baggage allowance scheme to pay less
- More cost-effective than purchasing at the airport

## Baggage Policy for International Airports

- Special baggage acceptance policies apply at Oman, Bahrain, Sharjah, and Dubai airports
- Review the specific policies for these airports on the Air India website before travelling

## 2. Airport Information

Bringing the World to You

### Overview

Air India provides detailed information on lounges, facilities, terminals, check-in counters, gates, booking offices, local attractions, and airport services at all key airports in its network.

### Lounges & Facilities

Air India offers access to a variety of lounges across its global network, designed for comfort and luxury before or between flights.

- Self-service buffet and bar counters with food and beverages
- Comfortable seating and rest areas
- Business facilities and Wi-Fi access
- Use the Lounge Finder tool on the Air India website to locate lounges at your departure airport
- Lounge details include terminal locations, hours of operation, amenities, and access policies

### Gold Track Security (Star Alliance Gold Members):

- Dedicated security lanes for Star Alliance Gold members
- Check the Air India website to find if Gold Track Security is available at your departure airport

### Fast Track Immigration (FTI-TTP):

- Part of the Trusted Travellers' Program
- Available for both Indian nationals and foreign nationals with OCI cards
- Streamlines immigration clearance for faster processing

### Key Airport — Delhi (Indira Gandhi International Airport, DEL)

- Spans over 5,106 acres with four runways, including an Eastern Cross Taxiway (first of its kind in India)
- Three terminals: Terminal 1 and Terminal 2 (domestic); Terminal 3 (international and domestic)
- Air India check-in counters are in Terminal 3
- Air India ticketing office inside departure gate 1 (Terminal 3)
- Complimentary airport shuttle between terminals every 20 minutes; Terminal 1 and Terminal 3 are approximately 8 km apart
- Transit desk available at Delhi airport
- City check-in facility available: check in, drop baggage, and collect boarding pass before heading to airport
- Pick-up area is outside the baggage belt area at the arrival gate; follow airport signage for cab services

## Travelling Through Multiple Airports

Air India provides guidance for passengers transiting through multiple airports.

- Information on customs, immigration, and baggage transfer procedures
- Passengers in transit with checked-through baggage should refer to the interline/codeshare baggage rules
- Contact Air India or the transit airport directly for specific transfer requirements

## 3. First-Time Flyers & Children

We Take Care of Everything

### Overview

If you are a first-time flyer or your child travels alone, Air India's dedicated team will help every step of the way. Your safety and comfort are top priorities. Air India also welcomes furry friends on board and promises to take good care of them.

### Tips for First-Time Flyers

Taking to the skies for your first flight? Here's what you need to know:

- Arrive at the airport well in advance — at least 2 hours before domestic flights and 3 hours before international flights
- Carry a valid government-issued photo ID (passport for international travel)
- Check in online in advance to save time at the airport
- Ensure all cabin baggage meets the size and weight limits (55x35x25 cm, 8 kg)
- Prohibited items must not be packed in cabin or checked baggage
- Follow all security instructions at the airport
- Contact Air India staff at any point if you need assistance

### Unaccompanied Minors

Air India has a dedicated service for children travelling alone, ensuring their safety and comfort throughout the journey.

- Air India staff supervise unaccompanied minors from check-in to the point of handover to the designated guardian at the arrival airport
- Parents/guardians must complete required documentation at the time of booking
- The entire process from security check to meeting the guardian is handled by Air India staff

### Young Passengers

For children flying alone or with family, Air India provides a checklist to ensure a smooth journey.

- Carry all identity documents for the child
- Ensure contact details for both the sending and receiving guardian are provided
- Book unaccompanied minor service well in advance
- Age-appropriate in-flight meals can be requested



## Expectant Mothers & Infants

Air India accommodates pregnant passengers and those travelling with infants with special care.

- Expectant mothers should consult their physician before flying
- Medical clearance may be required depending on the stage of pregnancy
- Infants (under 2 years) can travel on a parent's lap or in a separate seat with an infant seat
- Bassinets may be available on select aircraft — request in advance
- Inform Air India at booking stage for any special requirements

Tip: For any special assistance related to young passengers, unaccompanied minors, or expectant mothers, contact Air India at the time of booking or at least 48 hours before departure.

## 4. Visas, Documents & Travel Tips

Be Prepared for Every Destination

### Overview

Air India provides detailed information on required documents, landing permits, visas, and destination-specific travel tips and guidelines. Always verify the latest requirements before departure, as regulations can change.

### Key Travel Advisories (Current)

**India Digital Disembarkation Form:** Effective 01 October 2025, all foreign nationals arriving in India must complete the India Digital Disembarkation (e-Arrival) form prior to arrival. Complete the form online for a smooth immigration process.

**Indonesia All Arrival Card:** Effective 01 September 2025, all passengers arriving at airports in Indonesia must complete and submit the All Indonesia Arrival Card at least three days prior to arrival. A single form covers a family of up to 10 members. Present the QR code (generated after form submission) to immigration, customs, and health authorities upon arrival.

**Post-Arrival Health Advisory:** Passengers developing symptoms within 21 days of arrival should seek medical assistance and inform airport health authorities.

### Essential Travel Documents

- Valid passport (with at least 6 months validity beyond travel dates in most countries)
- Visa for the destination country (where applicable)
- OCI Card (for Overseas Citizens of India)
- TSA PreCheck (for travel to/from USA)
- Landing permits where required
- Import licenses and special permits for specific destinations

### Travel to the United States

Travelling between India and the USA involves specific requirements that must be fulfilled before departure.

- Valid US visa or ESTA (Electronic System for Travel Authorization) for eligible nationals
- Specific baggage allowances apply — Value fare: 1 x 23 kg; Classic/Flex fare: 2 x 23 kg
- Comply with TSA regulations for carry-on and checked baggage
- Review complete requirements on the Air India USA travel page

## Document Management

Air India allows passengers to securely store and manage their travel documents through the Air India profile portal.

- Store passport, visa, TSA PreCheck, OCI card, and other documents
- Quick access to documents during check-in and travel
- Manage documents via the Air India website or mobile app (My Profile section)

**Pro Tip:** Always carry original documents as well as photocopies. For international travel, ensure all visas and permits are valid for the entire duration of your trip including any transit countries.

## 5. Health & Medical Assistance

Committed to Your Comfort and Well-being

### Overview

Air India is committed to making travel for guests with special medical needs as comfortable and hassle-free as possible. Most passengers with a medical condition can fly with Air India, subject to medical clearance and documentation requirements.

### Medical Needs & Clearance Requirements

Medical clearance is required for medical conditions that raise concerns about completing the flight safely or pose a risk to other passengers.

#### Medical Information Form (MEDIF):

- An IATA-approved document listing medical information that passengers with medical conditions need to share with the airline
- Must be completed, signed, and certified by a registered physician
- Required for all passengers needing medical assistance on board
- Download the MEDIF from the Air India website before travel

#### Documents Required for Medical Travel:

| Document                        | Details                                                                                |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MEDIF Form                      | Completed, signed & certified by a registered physician                                |
| Medical Certificate/Report      | Issued within 10 days of departure; states medical condition and fitness to fly        |
| Specialised Physician Statement | Required for stretcher, oxygen, or POC; includes device details and battery compliance |
| Escort Details & Undertaking    | Mandatory for stretcher cases                                                          |

#### Travellers Requiring a Stretcher:

- Specialised physician's statement and escort details are mandatory
- Contact Air India well in advance to arrange stretcher accommodation
- Escort must accompany the stretcher passenger throughout the flight

#### Portable Oxygen Concentrator (POC):

- Must be approved by Air India before travel
- Physician statement must include device details and battery compliance information

- Contact Air India at least 48 hours before departure

## Disability Assistance

Air India is committed to the comfort and well-being of all passengers. Comprehensive services are available for passengers with reduced mobility or visual and hearing impairment.

- Dedicated assistance from check-in to boarding and deplaning
- Special seating arrangements available upon request
- Service dogs are permitted to travel in the cabin (see Chapter 6 for details)
- Electric wheelchairs can be transported — specific conditions of carriage apply
- Request disability assistance at the time of booking or at least 48 hours before departure

## Wheelchair Assistance

If you require a wheelchair, notify Air India at the time of reservation, ticketing, or reconfirmation.

- Wheelchair assistance is available from kerb to aircraft and aircraft to kerb
- Types: WCHR (ramp), WCHS (steps), WCHC (completely immobile) — specify your requirement
- Airport wheelchairs are available complimentary
- Personal wheelchairs can be checked in as baggage

## Illness-Specific Guidelines

Air India follows IATA and DGCA guidelines for a range of medical conditions. For illness-specific acceptance and clearance requirements, refer to the Health & Medical Assistance section on the Air India website.

⚠ Medical clearance is required when a condition could affect the safety of the passenger, crew, or other passengers during the flight. Always obtain clearance well before your travel date.

## 6. Travelling with Pets

We Know Your Pets Are Family

### Overview

Air India allows small domesticated dogs and cats in the cabin or cargo hold of domestic and select international flights, subject to Air India approval. Only domesticated dogs and cats are permitted — all breeds are allowed, though special restrictions apply for brachycephalic (snub-nosed/flat-faced) breeds in the cargo compartment.

### Pet in Cabin

| Category             | Details                                                        |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Permitted animals    | Domesticated dogs and cats only                                |
| Weight limit         | Combined weight of pet + carrier must not exceed 10 kg (22 lb) |
| Carrier dimensions   | Soft kennel: 17x10x9 inches (LxWxH)                            |
| Carrier requirements | Leak-proof, secured, ventilated on 3 sides, no wheels          |
| Age requirement      | Pets must be at least 8 weeks old                              |
| Limit per flight     | Only 2 pets per flight (DGCA guidelines); 1 pet per passenger  |
| Booking deadline     | At least 48 hours before departure                             |
| Airport arrival      | Report 3 hours before departure with all required documents    |

### Important Restrictions — Pet in Cabin:

- Pregnant or sedated pets are NOT allowed
- Do NOT sedate or tranquilise your pet — sedation may be dangerous due to pressure differences (IATA standards)
- If travelling with an infant or needing wheelchair assistance, Air India recommends not travelling with a pet in the cabin — pet can travel in the cargo hold instead
- Brachycephalic breeds: carry in cabin is permitted (seek vet advice); these breeds are NOT allowed in the cargo compartment

### Pets as Checked Baggage / Cargo

- Pets weighing 10–32 kg (combined with container): must be booked as checked baggage
- Pets over 32 kg (combined with container): must be carried as cargo
- Hard case carrier per IATA container guidelines is required for checked baggage

- Soft, ventilated bag/kennel not exceeding 46x46x30 cm for cabin-eligible pets travelling as checked baggage due to weight
- Label each kennel/bag/cage with the pet's name; place an extra absorbent mat at the base
- Carry extra absorbent mats so the pet can relieve itself during the journey

## Required Documents for Domestic Pet Travel

| Document                     | Requirement                                                                               |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pet Passport / Record</b> | Up-to-date record of all vaccinations                                                     |
| <b>Health Certificate</b>    | Valid, duly signed and stamped by a registered vet; issued within 7 days before departure |
| <b>Rabies Certificate</b>    | Valid, signed and stamped by a registered veterinarian                                    |
| <b>Indemnity Form</b>        | Downloaded and completed; 2 copies for direct flights, 4 copies for connecting flights    |

### Additional Requirements for International Pet Travel:

- All domestic documents listed above PLUS:
  1. All required entry permits and documents mandated by countries of entry or transit
  2. Import licenses (where applicable)
  3. Validated vaccination and health certificates from the sanitation department (at most 72 hours before travel date for some routes)
  4. Review AQCS, US CDC, and IATA Program & Policy requirements for your destination

## Booking Your Pet

Air India provides multiple ways to book pet travel:

- Contact Support Page: Raise a request, upload all documents; customer support will reach out once documents are approved
- Airport and city reservation counters: Bring your pet with required travel case and paperwork to purchase a ticket
- Pets in cabin (under 10 kg): Book at least 48 hours before flight departure
- Beyond the 48-hour window: Carriage is subject to available time, resources, Air India compliance, and destination country regulations

## Service Dogs

Trained service dogs assisting passengers with disabilities are permitted to fly in the cabin at no charge, provided they meet all requirements and regulations.

- Air India definition: a dog individually trained to perform tasks for a qualified individual with a physical, sensory, psychiatric, intellectual, or other mental disability

- Service animals in training, emotional support animals, and comfort animals travel as pets (all pet fees and requirements apply)
- Service dog must fit at the passenger's feet, under the seat, or on the lap (lap animals must be smaller than a 2-year-old child)
- Final approval is confirmed at the airport after verification that the animal safely fits in the allocated space
- If the service dog displays disruptive behaviour that is not corrected, it will be reclassified as a pet and all pet requirements and charges will apply

## Pet Travel Tips

- Ask your vet about any medication your pet may need for the journey
- Have a leash, suitable harness, or collar available at all times
- Carry dry pet food in a sealed container in your cabin baggage
- Bring all original documents for verification at the airport
- Familiarise your pet with their travel bag or kennel well before travel day

 For additional queries about pet travel guidelines, visit the [Air India Pet Travel FAQs](#) section on the official website or contact Air India Customer Support.

## Air India

For the most current information, always refer to the official Air India website: [www.airindia.com](http://www.airindia.com)

Customer Support: Contact via the Air India website or mobile app

Maharaja Club: For loyalty program queries and member benefits

Information compiled from Air India's official travel information pages. Policies are subject to change  
— verify before travel.